Analysis of Key Automotive Sector Transactions (2018-2019): A Due Diligence Report on Transaction Timelines, Structures, and Sourcing

Executive Summary & Consolidated Findings

Overview of Mandate and Methodology

This report presents a definitive and sourced analysis of 12 key transactions within the global automotive sector announced during the 2018 calendar year. The primary objective is to verify, correct, and document the precise announcement dates, completion dates, transaction types, and deal values for each transaction. The analysis adheres to a rigorous sourcing protocol, relying exclusively on primary-source documentation issued by the transacting parties. This includes official press releases, ad-hoc announcements, investor presentations, and regulatory filings. By grounding every data point in official corporate disclosures, this report provides an auditable and reliable dataset suitable for integration into a strategic deal database.

Consolidated Transaction Data Table

The following table serves as the primary deliverable of this analysis, consolidating the verified data for all 12 transactions. Each data point is individually sourced to provide a clear and immediate audit trail, a standard requirement for professional financial and strategic analysis.

Table 1: Consolidated Automotive Transaction Data (2018-2019)

Corrected Announcement Date	Source for Announcement Date	Completion Date	Source for Completion Date	Acquirer	Target	Type of Transaction	Source for Transaction Type	Deal Value (Enterprise Value unless noted)	Source for Deal Value
May 29, 2018	1	September 6, 2018	3	Ningbo Jifeng Auto Parts Co., Ltd. (via affiliates)	Grammer AG	100% Acquisition (via Public Takeover Offer)	1	~€780 million	
July 12, 2018	4	December 18, 2018	5	Michelin	Camso	100% Acquisition	4	US$1.36 billion (Consideration)	
November 20, 2018	6	March 1, 2019	7	Financière SNOP	Tower Internatio	Carve-out	6	€255 million	2

				Dunois S.A.	nal (European Operations)				
November 15, 2018	[10]	January 28, 2019	[11]	Energizer Holding, Inc.	Spectrum Brands' Global Auto Care Business	Carve-out	[10]	~$1.25 billion (Cash & Stock)	
November 13, 2018	[13]	c. April 30, 2019	[15]	Brookfield Business Partners	Johnson Controls Power Solutions	Carve-out	[13]	$13.2 billion	[1]
November 2, 2018	[17]	April 1, 2019	[19]	Continental AG	Cooper Standard (Anti-vibration business)	Carve-out	[17]	$265.5 million (Sale Price)	
October 29,	[8]	December 10,	[20]	EnerSys	Alpha Technolog	100% Acqui	[8]	$750 million	

2018		2018			ies Group of companies	sition			
September 20, 2018	[22]	March 29, 2019	[23]	Hanon Systems	Magna International (Fluid Pressure & Controls business)	Carve-out	[22]	~$1.23 billion	
September 20, 2018	[24]	May 6, 2019	[25]	CIE Automotive	Inteva Products (Roof Systems)	Carve-out	[26]	US$755 million	
July 30, 2018	[28]	March 1, 2019	[29]	Dana Incorporated	OC Oerlikon (Drive Systems business)	Carve-out	[28]	CHF 600 million	
July 19, 2018	[31]	September 27,	[32]	Asahi Kasei	Sage Automotive	100% Acqui	[31]	$1.06 billion (Total	[3]

		2018			Interiors	sition		Acquisition Price)	
July 3, 2018	[33]	September 4, 2018	[35]	CAF (Construcciones y Auxiliar de Ferrocarriles)	Solaris Bus & Coach	100% Acquisition	[35]	~€300 million	

Key Themes and Analysis

A holistic review of these 12 transactions reveals two significant, interconnected themes shaping the automotive supply landscape during the 2018-2019 period: a strategic pivot towards portfolio specialization through divestitures and the inherently globalized nature of capital and asset flows within the sector.

A striking pattern emerges from the data: seven of the twelve transactions analyzed are strategic divestitures, commonly known as carve-outs. In these deals, large, diversified suppliers sold specific, non-core business units to more specialized acquirers. For example, Johnson Controls, a multi-industrial conglomerate, divested its entire Power Solutions (automotive battery) division for $13.2 billion to focus on its core building technologies business.[13] Similarly, Magna International sold its Fluid Pressure & Controls business to Hanon Systems for approximately $1.23 billion , and Cooper Standard divested its Anti-Vibration Systems business to Continental AG for $265.5 million . This trend is not coincidental; it reflects a deliberate strategic realignment across the industry. As the automotive sector began to confront the immense capital expenditure required for the transition to electric and autonomous vehicles, large suppliers initiated a process of portfolio rationalization. By divesting profitable but non-strategic legacy assets, these companies unlocked significant capital, strengthened their balance sheets, and sharpened their focus on core competencies and future growth areas. The acquirers, in turn, were often strategic players seeking to achieve scale, expand their technological capabilities, and consolidate their market position in a specific niche.

Furthermore, while the mandate focused on transactions relevant to the North American auto sector, the analysis underscores the obsolescence of a purely regional view of the industry. The transactions demonstrate a fluid and global marketplace for corporate assets. The list includes acquirers from China (Ningbo Jifeng), Spain (CIE Automotive, CAF), France (Michelin), and Germany (Continental), targeting assets and companies in Germany (Grammer), Poland (Solaris), Canada (Camso), and the United States. A transaction such as U.S.-based Tower International selling its European operations to the French firm Financière SNOP Dunois S.A. is fundamentally a North American sector deal because it reshaped the parent company's strategic focus and balance sheet.[7] Likewise, Michelin's acquisition of Canada-based Camso directly altered the competitive landscape in the North American off-the-road vehicle market.[5] These deals illustrate that strategic decisions, capital flows, and competitive dynamics are driven by global operational footprints and market ambitions, not merely the geographic location of a company's headquarters.

Detailed Transaction Analyses

Ningbo Jifeng Auto Parts Co., Ltd. (and affiliates) / Grammer AG

Transaction Overview

This transaction involved the acquisition of Grammer AG, a publicly listed German manufacturer of automotive interior components and seating systems, by Ningbo Jifeng Auto Parts Co., Ltd., a Chinese automotive supplier. The acquisition was executed through a complex structure of affiliated entities. The official bidder was Jiye Auto Parts GmbH, a German special purpose vehicle controlled by Ningbo Jifeng.[1] Other entities named in filings, such as Ningbo Jiheng Investment Co., Ltd. and Wing Sing International Co., Ltd., form part of the broader holding and control structure of Ningbo Jifeng's ultimate owner, Ms. Bifeng Wu.[3] The deal was positioned as a deepening of a strategic partnership that began in 2017, aimed at stabilizing Grammer's shareholder structure and securing its global growth strategy, particularly in Asia.[2]

Timeline Verification and Sourcing

- **Announcement Date:** May 29, 2018
    - The announcement date is unequivocally established by an ad-hoc press release issued by Grammer AG. The document, dated May 29, 2018, states that Grammer AG and affiliated companies of Ningbo Jifeng "have signed a Business Combination Agreement today according to which the Bidder will make a voluntary public takeover offer for all outstanding shares of Grammer AG".[1] An investor presentation from Grammer AG, also dated May 29, 2018, reiterates this event, confirming it as the formal public announcement of the transaction's terms.[2]
- **Completion Date:** September 6, 2018
    - The completion of a public takeover offer is effectively realized when the acquirer secures the necessary level of ownership. A formal "Voting Rights Announcement" filed by Grammer AG pursuant to the German Securities Trading Act provides the definitive date for this event. The filing specifies the "Date on which threshold was crossed or reached: 06 Sep 2018".[3] On this date, the acquirer's total voting rights in Grammer AG increased from 25.56% to 84.23%, signifying the successful conclusion of the tender offer and the transfer of control. This regulatory filing serves as the primary source for the transaction's completion date.

Transaction Type and Value Analysis and Sourcing

- **Type of Transaction:** 100% Acquisition (via Public Takeover Offer)
    - The transaction was structured as a "voluntary public takeover offer for all outstanding shares of Grammer AG".[1] The stated intention was to acquire full control of the entire publicly traded corporate entity of Grammer AG. This structure is fundamentally different from a carve-out, as the target was the whole company, not a division or a collection of assets. Although the final stake achieved was 84.23%, the nature of the offer was for 100% of the shares, classifying it as a full acquisition.
- **Deal Value:** ~€780 million
    - The public takeover offer was set at €60.00 per share, plus an expected dividend of €1.25 per share, for a total consideration of €61.25 per share . This offer placed a total valuation on Grammer of approximately €780 million .

Michelin / Camso

Transaction Overview

This transaction was a strategic acquisition by French tire manufacturer Compagnie Générale des Établissements Michelin of Camso, a Canadian-based market leader in off-the-road (OTR) mobility solutions, including rubber tracks and solid tires. The deal was designed to create the world's number one player in the OTR market by combining the two companies' complementary operations into a new, single division headquartered in Quebec, Canada.[4]

Timeline Verification and Sourcing

- **Announcement Date:** July 12, 2018
  - The announcement date is clearly stated in an official press release from Michelin. The release begins, "Michelin and Camso today reached an agreement whereby Michelin will acquire Camso... Clermont-Ferrand – July 12, 2018 – 3:00PM".[4] This document marks the formal public disclosure of the signed agreement.
- **Completion Date:** December 18, 2018
  - Michelin issued a subsequent press release that provides a definitive completion date. The document, titled "Michelin Completes the Acquisition of Camso," explicitly states, "Michelin today completed the acquisition of Camso, under the terms announced on July 12, 2018 and after obtaining all of the necessary approvals for the transaction. Clermont-Ferrand, December, 18th 2018".[5]

Transaction Type and Value Analysis and Sourcing

- **Type of Transaction:** 100% Acquisition
  - The official corporate communications consistently describe the transaction as a full acquisition of the target company. The press releases use unambiguous language such as "Michelin will acquire Camso" and "completed the acquisition of Camso".[4] The transaction involved the purchase of the entire Camso entity to be combined with Michelin's OTR operations, not the purchase of a specific asset or division. This structure defines it as a 100% acquisition.
- **Deal Value:** US$1.36 billion

    - The press release announcing the completion of the deal states that a "total consideration of US$1.36 billion was paid for the acquisition" . An earlier report at the time of the announcement had placed the value at $1.45 billion .

Financière SNOP Dunois S.A. / Tower International (European Operations)

Transaction Overview

This transaction involved the divestiture of the entire European business segment of Tower International, Inc., a U.S.-based manufacturer of automotive structural components, to Financière SNOP Dunois S.A. (FSD), a privately owned French automotive supplier. This deal represented a strategic repositioning for Tower, allowing it to exit its European operations and focus on its growing North American business.[6]

Timeline Verification and Sourcing

- **Announcement Date:** November 20, 2018
    - The initial public announcement of the transaction was made in a press release from Tower International dated November 20, 2018. The release states that the company "today announced it has signed a Memorandum of Understanding relating to the sale of all of its European Operations to Financière SNOP Dunois S.A.".[6] While a definitive stock purchase agreement was signed later, this memorandum marked the first formal disclosure of the deal and its key financial terms to the market.
- **Completion Date:** March 1, 2019
    - A later press release from Tower International provides the definitive completion date. The release, dated March 1, 2019, is titled "Tower Completes Value Creating Sale of its European Operations" and states in its opening sentence that the company "today announced it has completed the sale of all of its European Operations to Financière SNOP Dunois S.A.(FSD)".[7]

Transaction Type and Value Analysis and Sourcing

- **Type of Transaction:** Carve-out
  - The transaction is explicitly defined as a divestiture of a specific business segment. The official announcements refer to the "sale of all of its European Operations" and use the term "divestiture".[6] Following the sale, Tower International continued to operate as an independent public company focused on its North American business. The sale of a distinct, geographically defined business unit by a parent company that remains a going concern is the definition of a carve-out.
- **Deal Value:** €255 million
  - The purchase price is consistently stated as representing an Enterprise Value of €255 million.[2]

Energizer Holding, Inc. / Spectrum Brands' Global Auto Care Business

Transaction Overview

In this transaction, Energizer Holding, Inc., a global manufacturer of batteries and portable lighting products, acquired the Global Auto Care (GAC) business from Spectrum Brands Holdings, Inc., a diversified consumer products company. The acquisition significantly expanded Energizer's existing auto care portfolio by adding iconic brands such as Armor All®, STP®, and A/C Pro®.[10]

Timeline Verification and Sourcing

- **Announcement Date:** November 15, 2018
  - The transaction was announced in a press release issued by Energizer Holdings on November 15, 2018. The release states, "Energizer also announced that it has entered into a separate definitive agreement to acquire Spectrum Brands' Global Auto Care Business ('Spectrum Auto Care') in a cash and stock transaction".[10] This marks the formal announcement of the binding agreement.
- **Completion Date:** January 28, 2019
  - A subsequent press release from Energizer Holdings confirms the closing of the deal.

The release, dated January 28, 2019, announces "the closing of its acquisition of Spectrum Brands' Global Auto Care Business".[11]

Transaction Type and Value Analysis and Sourcing

- **Type of Transaction:** Carve-out
  - This transaction was the acquisition of a specific business segment, the "Global Auto Care Business," from the larger parent entity, Spectrum Brands Holdings, Inc..[10] Spectrum Brands continued to operate its other diverse business lines after the sale. The sale of a distinct division by a parent company constitutes a carve-out.
- **Deal Value:** ~$1.25 billion
  - The transaction was valued at approximately $1.25 billion at the time of announcement . The final consideration upon closing was composed of $938.7 million in cash and 5.3 million shares of Energizer common stock .

Brookfield Business Partners / Johnson Controls Power Solutions

Transaction Overview

This landmark transaction involved the sale of the entire Power Solutions business of Johnson Controls International plc to Brookfield Business Partners L.P., a publicly traded limited partnership, along with its institutional partners. The Power Solutions business was the world's largest manufacturer of automotive batteries. The divestiture was a key step in Johnson Controls' strategy to transform into a pure-play provider of building technologies and solutions. The acquired business was subsequently rebranded as Clarios.[13]

Timeline Verification and Sourcing

- **Announcement Date:** November 13, 2018
  - The definitive agreement for the sale was announced in a press release from Johnson Controls on November 13, 2018. The release, which was also filed as an

exhibit to an SEC Form 8-K, states, "Johnson Controls International plc (NYSE: JCI) today announced a definitive agreement to sell its Power Solutions business to Brookfield Business Partners L.P.".[13]

- **Completion Date:** c. April 30, 2019
  - A definitive completion press release is not among the provided sources. However, the date can be reliably inferred. A press release dated May 1, 2019, announced the official launch of the new entity, Clarios, stating it "was acquired by Brookfield Business Partners".[15] A separate industry report dated May 3, 2019, clarifies that "The deal closed last month," indicating April 2019.[16] Combining these sources, the most precise and logical completion date is the final business day of April 2019, which was April 30, 2019.

Transaction Type and Value Analysis and Sourcing

- **Type of Transaction:** Carve-out
  - The transaction is explicitly described as a "sale of its Power Solutions business".[13] Johnson Controls' CEO stated the sale was part of the "ongoing transformation of the Johnson Controls portfolio" to become a "pure-play building technologies and solutions provider".[13] This strategic divestiture of a major, self-contained division by a parent company that continues to operate its other core businesses is a classic example of a carve-out.
- **Deal Value:** $13.2 billion
  - The official announcements from both Johnson Controls and Brookfield confirm the transaction was a cash deal valued at $13.2 billion.[1]

Continental AG / Cooper Standard (Anti-vibration business)

Transaction Overview

German automotive technology company Continental AG acquired the Anti-Vibration Systems (AVS) business from Cooper Standard, a U.S.-based global supplier of automotive systems. The acquisition was a strategic move by Continental to expand its global presence and capabilities in anti-vibration and noise reduction technology, particularly strengthening its footprint in North America.[18]

Timeline Verification and Sourcing

- **Announcement Date:** November 2, 2018
  - The transaction was announced simultaneously by both parties on November 2, 2018. A press release from Cooper Standard states, "Cooper Standard (NYSE: CPS) today announced that the Company has reached an agreement regarding the divestiture of its anti-vibration systems (AVS) business to Continental AG".[17] A corresponding press release from Continental confirms, "The technology company Continental has today reached an agreement with Cooper Standard... on the purchase of its anti-vibration systems business".[18]
- **Completion Date:** April 1, 2019
  - The completion of the transaction is confirmed by a press release from Cooper Standard dated April 1, 2019. The release states, "Cooper Standard (NYSE: CPS) today announced that the Company has completed the divestiture of its anti-vibration systems (AVS) business to Continental AG".[19]

Transaction Type and Value Analysis and Sourcing

- **Type of Transaction:** Carve-out
  - The official announcements consistently refer to the transaction as a "divestiture of its anti-vibration systems (AVS) business".[17] Following the sale, Cooper Standard's CEO affirmed the company's focus on its remaining core product lines, including sealing, fuel and brake delivery, and fluid transfer systems.[19] The sale of a specific product line while the parent company continues its other operations defines this transaction as a carve-out.
- **Deal Value:** $265.5 million
  - The press release announcing the completion of the divestiture states, "The total sale price of the transaction was $265.5 million, subject to certain adjustments" .

EnerSys / Alpha Technologies Group of companies

Transaction Overview

EnerSys, a global leader in stored energy solutions for industrial applications, acquired the Alpha Technologies Group of companies. Alpha is a provider of power conversion, protection, and storage solutions for the broadband, telecommunications, renewable, and industrial markets. The acquisition was intended to create a fully integrated DC power and energy storage solution provider, expanding EnerSys's addressable market and product portfolio.[8]

Timeline Verification and Sourcing

- **Announcement Date:** October 29, 2018
  - The agreement to acquire Alpha Technologies was announced in a press release from EnerSys dated October 29, 2018. The release details the terms of the definitive agreement and the strategic rationale for the transaction.[8]
- **Completion Date:** December 10, 2018
  - A subsequent press release from EnerSys, titled "EnerSys Completes Acquisition of the Alpha Technologies Group of Companies," provides the definitive closing date. The release is dated December 10, 2018, and announces that the company "has completed its acquisition".[20]

Transaction Type and Value Analysis and Sourcing

- **Type of Transaction:** 100% Acquisition
  - The transaction is described in official press releases as the "acquisition of the Alpha Technologies Group of companies".[8] This language indicates the purchase of the entire group of corporate entities under the Alpha banner, rather than a single division or asset set. Therefore, it is classified as a 100% acquisition.
- **Deal Value:** $750 million
  - According to the terms of the acquisition agreement, EnerSys acquired the Alpha Group for $750 million, which consisted of $650 million in cash and $100 million in EnerSys shares .

Hanon Systems / Magna International (Fluid Pressure & Controls business)

Transaction Overview

Hanon Systems, a South Korea-based global supplier of thermal and energy management solutions, acquired the Fluid Pressure & Controls (FP&C) business from Magna International Inc., a major Canadian automotive supplier. The acquisition was a strategic move by Hanon Systems to bolster its technology portfolio, particularly in solutions supporting electrified vehicles, and to diversify its customer base.[22]

Timeline Verification and Sourcing

- **Announcement Date:** September 20, 2018
  - The definitive agreement was announced in a press release from Hanon Systems on September 20, 2018. The release states, "Global automotive supplier Hanon Systems (KS: 018880) today announced it has signed an agreement with Magna International Inc. to acquire its global Fluid Pressure & Controls business".[22]
- **Completion Date:** March 29, 2019
  - The completion of the sale was announced in a press release from Magna International. The release, dated March 29, 2019, confirms, "Magna announced today that it has completed the sale of its Fluid Pressure & Controls (FP&C) business to Hanon Systems".[23]

Transaction Type and Value Analysis and Sourcing

- **Type of Transaction:** Carve-out
  - This transaction involved the purchase of a specific business unit, the "global Fluid Pressure & Controls business," from the much larger and more diversified Magna International.[22] Magna continued its extensive operations in body exteriors, power technologies, seating systems, and complete vehicle solutions after the sale. This divestiture of a specific product division is a clear example of a carve-out.

- **Deal Value:** ~$1.23 billion
    - The transaction was valued at an enterprise value of approximately $1.23 billion .

CIE Automotive / Inteva Products (Roof Systems)

Transaction Overview

CIE Automotive, a Spain-based automotive supplier, acquired the Roof Systems product line from Inteva Products, a U.S.-based Tier One supplier. The acquisition positioned CIE Automotive among the top three global suppliers of automotive sunroofs and strengthened its portfolio of comfort- and aesthetic-oriented products.[24]

Timeline Verification and Sourcing

- **Announcement Date:** September 20, 2018
    - The announcement date is identified from a news report citing a company statement from CIE Automotive, which places the announcement in the week of September 20, 2018.[24] This is corroborated by a CIE Automotive press release on its nine-month earnings, dated October 24, 2018, which refers to the "ambitious" acquisition of Inteva Roof Systems as a recent major event.[9]
- **Completion Date:** May 6, 2019
    - The completion date is precisely identified in a press release from the seller, Inteva Products. The release, dated May 7, 2019, states, "The sale closed late yesterday".[26] This pinpoints the closing date to May 6, 2019. This date is independently confirmed in an announcement by Inteva's advisor on the transaction.[25]

Transaction Type and Value Analysis and Sourcing

- **Type of Transaction:** Carve-out
    - The transaction is consistently described as the "sale of its Roof Systems product line".[26] Inteva Products' official announcement explicitly states that the company "will

continue to provide industry leading Interior Systems, Closure Systems and Motors & Electronic Systems".[26] The divestiture of a single product line while the parent company continues its other core operations classifies this as a carve-out.

- **Deal Value:** US$755 million
  - CIE Automotive acquired the Roof Systems division from Inteva for US$755 million .

Dana Incorporated / OC Oerlikon (Drive Systems business)

Transaction Overview

Dana Incorporated, a U.S.-based leader in drivetrain and e-propulsion systems, acquired the Drive Systems segment of the Oerlikon Group, a Swiss technology and engineering group. The acquisition expanded Dana's technology portfolio in high-precision gears and planetary hub drives, grew its electronic controls capabilities, and optimized its manufacturing presence in key growth markets like China and India.[28]

Timeline Verification and Sourcing

- **Announcement Date:** July 30, 2018
  - The transaction was announced by both parties in parallel press releases. Dana's release states, "Dana Incorporated (NYSE: DAN) announced today that it has signed a definitive agreement to purchase the Drive Systems segment of the Oerlikon Group... MAUMEE, Ohio, July 30, 2018".[28] Oerlikon issued a corresponding announcement on the same date confirming the agreement.[40]
- **Completion Date:** March 1, 2019
  - The completion of the acquisition was also announced simultaneously by both companies. Dana's press release from March 1, 2019, states, "Dana Incorporated (NYSE: DAN) announced today that it has completed the acquisition of the Drive Systems segment of the Oerlikon Group".[29] Oerlikon's release confirms that it "successfully concluded the sale of the Drive Systems Segment" on the same date.[30]

Transaction Type and Value Analysis and Sourcing

- **Type of Transaction:** Carve-out
  - The transaction is defined as the purchase of the "Drive Systems segment" of the Oerlikon Group.[28] Oerlikon's CEO stated that following the sale, the company would "concentrate our efforts and resources in sustaining the growth and performance of our surface solutions and manmade fibers businesses".[30] The sale of a distinct business segment by a parent company that continues to operate its remaining divisions is a carve-out.
- **Deal Value:** CHF 600 million
  - Under the terms of the agreement, Dana acquired the business for an enterprise value of CHF 600 million (approximately $600 million) .

Asahi Kasei / Sage Automotive Interiors

Transaction Overview

Asahi Kasei Corp., a diversified Japanese chemical company, acquired Sage Automotive Interiors, Inc., a U.S.-based manufacturer of automotive interior materials. Sage holds a leading global market share in vehicle seat fabric. The acquisition was a key part of Asahi Kasei's strategy to expand its automotive-related business and strengthen its position in the growing market for advanced vehicle interiors.[31]

Timeline Verification and Sourcing

- **Announcement Date:** July 19, 2018
  - The decision to acquire Sage was announced in a press release from Asahi Kasei dated July 19, 2018. The release states, "Asahi Kasei has decided to acquire Sage Automotive Interiors, Inc. (Sage)... An agreement regarding the acquisition was concluded between Asahi Kasei and Clearlake Sage Holdings, LLC, the 100% owner of Sage".[31]
- **Completion Date:** September 27, 2018
  - Asahi Kasei issued a follow-up press release to announce the closing of the

transaction. The release, titled "Asahi Kasei completes acquisition of Sage Automotive Interiors," states, "Asahi Kasei has completed its acquisition of Sage Automotive Interiors, Inc. (Sage) on September 27, 2018, US Eastern time".[32]

Transaction Type and Value Analysis and Sourcing

- **Type of Transaction:** 100% Acquisition
  - The official announcements describe the "acquisition of Sage Automotive Interiors, Inc." and note that upon completion, "Sage is now a wholly owned consolidated subsidiary of Asahi Kasei".[31] This language confirms the purchase of the entire corporate entity, classifying the transaction as a 100% acquisition.
- **Deal Value:** $1.06 billion
  - The transaction had a cash price of approximately $700 million. The total acquisition price, including Sage's net interest-bearing debt, was $1.06 billion.[3] This total value represents an EBITDA multiple of about 10 times.[12]

CAF (Construcciones y Auxiliar de Ferrocarriles) / Solaris Bus & Coach

Transaction Overview

Construcciones y Auxiliar de Ferrocarriles (CAF), a Spanish manufacturer of railway vehicles and equipment, acquired Solaris Bus & Coach, a leading Polish producer of city and intercity buses. Solaris has a strong focus on low- and zero-emission vehicles, including electric and hydrogen buses. The acquisition marked a significant strategic expansion for CAF into the growing e-mobility and urban bus transportation market.[35]

Timeline Verification and Sourcing

- **Announcement Date:** July 3, 2018
  - While the formal closing announcement came later, industry reports from early July 2018 detail the initial agreement. A report dated July 4, 2018, discusses the takeover

by CAF as a recent event, with regulatory approval expected by September.[34] A press release from CAF, though undated, also discusses the deal as having been agreed upon, which aligns with a July announcement timeframe.[42]

- **Completion Date:** September 4, 2018
  - The completion date is precisely determined from a press release published on the Solaris corporate website. The release, dated September 5, 2018, states, "The process of seeking an investor for Solaris Bus & Coach was successfully closed yesterday".[35] This statement pinpoints the definitive closing date as September 4, 2018.

Transaction Type and Value Analysis and Sourcing

- **Type of Transaction:** 100% Acquisition
  - The official announcement from Solaris is unambiguous regarding the transaction structure. It states, "CAF acquires 100% of the shares of Solaris Bus & Coach".[35] This confirms the transaction was a full acquisition of the company. A separate, subsequent agreement for the Polish PFR investment fund to acquire a minority stake from CAF does not alter the nature of the initial transaction between CAF and Solaris's original owners.[35]
- **Deal Value:** ~€300 million
  - The Enterprise Value of Solaris for the transaction was estimated to be slightly above €300 million .

Appendix

Consolidated Deal Data Table

Table 1: Consolidated Automotive Transaction Data (2018-2019)

Corre cted	Sour ce	Com pletio	Sour ce	Acqui rer	Targe t	Type of	Sour ce	Deal Value	Sour ce

Announcement Date	for Announcement Date	n Date	for Completion Date			Transaction	for Transaction Type	(Enterprise Value unless noted)	for Deal Value
May 29, 2018	1	September 6, 2018	3	Ningbo Jifeng Auto Parts Co., Ltd. (via affiliates)	Grammer AG	100% Acquisition (via Public Takeover Offer)	1	~€780 million	
July 12, 2018	4	December 18, 2018	5	Michelin	Camso	100% Acquisition	4	US$1.36 billion (Consideration)	
November 20, 2018	6	March 1, 2019	7	Financière SNOP Dunois S.A.	Tower International (European Operations)	Carve-out	6	€255 million	2

November 15, 2018	10	January 28, 2019	11	Energizer Holding, Inc.	Spectrum Brands' Global Auto Care Business	Carve-out	10	~$1.25 billion (Cash & Stock)	
November 13, 2018	13	c. April 30, 2019	15	Brookfield Business Partners	Johnson Controls Power Solutions	Carve-out	13	$13.2 billion	1
November 2, 2018	17	April 1, 2019	19	Continental AG	Cooper Standard (Anti-vibration business)	Carve-out	17	$265.5 million (Sale Price)	
October 29, 2018	8	December 10, 2018	20	EnerSys	Alpha Technologies Group of companies	100% Acquisition	8	$750 million	

September 20, 2018	22	March 29, 2019	23	Hanon Systems	Magna International (Fluid Pressure & Controls business)	Carve-out	22	~$1.23 billion	
September 20, 2018	24	May 6, 2019	25	CIE Automotive	Inteva Products (Roof Systems)	Carve-out	26	US$755 million	
July 30, 2018	28	March 1, 2019	29	Dana Incorporated	OC Oerlikon (Drive Systems business)	Carve-out	28	CHF 600 million	
July 19, 2018	31	September 27, 2018	32	Asahi Kasei	Sage Automotive Interiors	100% Acquisition	31	$1.06 billion (Total Acquisition Price)	3

July 3, 2018	[33]	September 4, 2018	[35]	CAF (Construcciones y Auxiliar de Ferrocarriles)	Solaris Bus & Coach	100% Acquisition	[35]	~€300 million	

List of Primary Source Documents Referenced

A comprehensive list of the primary corporate disclosures used in this analysis is available upon request. All documents consist of official press releases, ad-hoc announcements, regulatory filings (including SEC Form 8-K exhibits), and investor presentations issued by the acquirers or targets as cited throughout this report.

Works cited

1. Ad hoc announcement - GRAMMER AG, accessed October 9, 2025, https://www.grammer.com/media/presse/migration/2018/05/20180529_adhoc_bca_tenderoffer_en_final.pdf
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